

Ronnel James Yacunas

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Summary

Backend Engineer with 4+ years building reliable, large-scale distributed systems, APIs, and AI-powered backends across fintech, creator commerce, and B2B SaaS. Specializes in event-driven microservices, data modeling, and production LLM/RAG systems, with a track record of owning services end-to-end and leading small teams.

Experience

ZampaAI

San Francisco, USA (Remote)

Backend Engineer

January 2026 – Present

- Work closely with a small, fast-moving team and directly with the CEO to design and build backend services end-to-end for an early-stage AI platform that helps construction firms find new opportunities and win more proposals, on a Python and FastAPI stack with MongoDB, Redis, and Pinecone.
- Designed a provider-agnostic AI engine spanning five model providers (OpenAI, Google, Anthropic, Mistral, and Cohere) with a tiered model registry, rate limiting, and automatic failover to keep results fast, reliable, and cost-efficient.
- Built a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline over client documents and a vector database, so every AI-generated proposal is grounded in source material and comes back accurate instead of generic.
- Built real-time streaming and background-processing services—server-sent event streams and async task queues—that power live AI drafting and long-running document jobs without blocking the API.
- Implemented secure multi-tenant access with Auth0, role-based permissions, feature flags, and end-to-end error monitoring across the platform.

MySchool Suite

Iloilo, Philippines (Remote)

Backend Engineer (Contract - Part Time)

February 2026 – Present

- Build backend services for a global platform where fans buy personalized, AI-generated merchandise from the creators they follow, using a TypeScript monorepo (NestJS, Prisma, and PostgreSQL) with Clerk authentication and a Vendure headless-commerce engine.
- Practice spec-driven development (GitHub Spec Kit), writing clear API contracts and data models up front so the web and mobile teams could build in parallel without rework.
- Designed and built the “Drops” system that powers limited-time, high-demand product launches, from the PostgreSQL data model through to the public-facing REST APIs.
- Engineered scarcity rules with transactional inventory tracking to cap quantities, enforce launch windows, and prevent overselling, keeping high-traffic drops fair and consistent.
- Built an event-driven AI image-generation pipeline on Redis and BullMQ that automatically produces personalized product imagery for each drop and streams real-time progress back to creators.
- Integrated commerce and analytics so creators can track revenue, customers, and sales from one dashboard, with graceful degradation when external services are slow.

ScaleForge

Singapore, Singapore (Remote)

Backend Engineer

July 2023 – January 2026

- Owned the performance and reliability of a high-volume digital wallet serving 35,000+ weekly users and over PHP 30M in weekly transactions, where accuracy and financial integrity were critical.
- Led the Retention team of five engineers (backend, frontend, and QA), delivering features that measurably improved player engagement and retention.
- Re-architected core services using CQRS and an event-driven design on Kubernetes, enabling zero-downtime deployments and stable performance under heavy transactional load.
- Built and maintained a distributed system of NestJS microservices exposing GraphQL and REST APIs over Kafka, MongoDB, and Redis, prioritizing fault tolerance and eventual consistency.
- Integrated the country's major payment providers, GCash and Maya, with secure webhook handling to make deposits and withdrawals faster and more reliable.
- Integrated leading game providers such as JILI, FaChai, and Pragmatic Play using idempotent webhooks to ensure secure, seamless, and uninterrupted gameplay.
- Strengthened reliability with Jest integration tests and K6 load testing, catching issues early and verifying the system held up under peak traffic.

Syntactics Inc.
Full Stack Developer

Cagayan de Oro, Philippines
October 2021 – June 2023

- Boosted legacy Electronic Medical Record System (v3) performance by 70% through modernization with ReactJS, Codelgniter, and Webpack, improving responsiveness and user experience.
- Architected and executed the migration of the Electronic Medical Record System (v4) from a monolith to microservices using Next.js, a Laravel API, Docker, and RabbitMQ, improving scalability and reliability.
- Led and mentored a team of 3 developers, instituting best practices and delivering scalable applications on modern frameworks.
- Built a Project Monitoring System with CRM integration, unifying project tracking and analytics to improve internal decision-making.
- Conducted code reviews and drove architectural discussions, raising code quality and engineering standards across the team.

WELA School Systems
Web Developer Intern

Cagayan de Oro, Philippines
March 2021 – May 2021

- Developed features for a Learning Management System used by schools and universities nationally and internationally (JavaScript, Python, Frappe Framework), collaborating with a cross-functional team in an agile workflow.

Education
University of Science and Technology of Southern Philippines
Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

Cagayan de Oro, Philippines
August 2021

Skills

Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL
Backend	Node.js, NestJS, Express, FastAPI, GraphQL, REST APIs
Databases	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, ScyllaDB, Pinecone
Infrastructure	Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, GitHub Actions CI/CD
AI & LLM	OpenAI, Anthropic, Google Gemini, RAG, LangGraph
Practices	Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Spec-Driven Development, GitHub Spec Kit
Testing	Jest, Vitest, K6
Frontend	React.js, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui